Principles of Diet

A high calorie, high protein, high carbohydrate, low fat, high fluid, low fibre and soft bland diet.

Dietary Management

- **Energy**: Energy utilization is high in fevers due to the high metabolic activities. The calorie requirement is increased about 50 percent. High carbohydrate drinks and cereal gruels can be included in frequent small feedings to meet high energy demand.
- **Proteins:** In prolonged fever 100g of good quality proteins have to be included. High protein beverages and soups can be included.
- **Carbohydrate:** Glucose can be used for sweetening beverages. Starchy gruels also supply carbohydrates.
- **Electrolytes**: Sodium chloride, has to be supplemented. Soups can meet this demand. Fruit juices and milk beverages can be given in considerable quantities.
- **Vitamin:** The requirement increases during fever. Vitamin A and ascorbic acid have to be supplemented; B complex vitamin intake has to be adjusted with calorie intake.
- **Fluid:** Intake must be liberal so as to meet the additional loss during fever. At least 3-5 litre of fluid intake is essential.

Dietary Guidelines

First clear fluid diet is given, followed by full fluid and soft diet. Bland, easily digestible foods must be used. Instead of a four-meal pattern, frequent small feedings are recommended.

Foods to be included	Foods to be avoided
Cereals, gruels. barley water, Thin dal, milk, curds, cottage cheese, milk shakes, custards, Poached Eggs, baked fish, double cooked minced meat, vegetable puree, Steamed vegetable, Fruit juices	Butter, ghee, vegetable oil, fibres, chilies and other spices, rich pastries, fried foods, puddings and cream soups

1.2.2 Tuberculosis

Tuberculosis is an infectious disease caused by the *bacillus Mycobacterium tuberculosis*. It affects the lungs, kidneys, alimentary tract, lymph nodes of the neck, liver, spleen, bones and joints of children.

Causes of Tuberculosis

It is an air borne infection. Congested dwelling and unhygienic living conditions are the main causes of this infection.

Symptoms of Tuberculosis

- Wasting of tissues
- Exhaustion
- Persistent cough
- Low-grade fever
- Loss of weight
- Pain in the chest
- Poor appetite
- Fatigue
- Sputum coughed up by the patient may become streaked with blood.